

Week 2: Video Transcript

Hello everyone and welcome to your very first session at the Jai Institute for Parenting. Today, we are going to be setting your intentions as an empowered parent, setting your intentions for how you long to move through this process, specifically as the client in our program for the next 12 weeks. And before we get there, I want to say a deep heartfelt thank you from me and all of us here at Jai, especially all of our graduates. We are a beautiful, strong, and driven community of women, men, mothers, fathers, grandparents, teachers, educators, therapists, doctors, and the average stay at home mom. And we are so happy that you have decided to join our community and our movement to create a world where children can walk through their life, believing that they're safe, unconditionally loved, and supported. And as well as parents, we can move through our day feeling safe and unconditionally loved and supported. And that is what we will be working together to strengthen and mend and gain new insight and tools. So let's get started.

My intention to you as your facilitator these next 12 weeks on these weekly videos, as well as in our weekly classes, is that you feel held in a way where you can take any sense of urgency and believing, fearing that you need to have a radically fast transformation in 12 weeks, and you've got to do it perfectly. I'm going to hold you and invite you every step of the way to set that down and to show up as you are, and to celebrate every step of the way. There are no quick fixes. We're not ripping off band-aids. We are moving together at the pace of permission for you. We are moving together in a way that will feel fun, and curious, and joyful, even when it hurts, because you know that you're supported here, and that you are wanted, you are welcome, and you belong. So if you have any butterflies in your tummy, feeling nervous about being in this process, having any fears, any thoughts in your mind about anything, I've heard them all. We're going to go ahead and have compassion for ourselves first of all, and have a nice deep exhale, and maybe even a wiggle, and to trust that you're in the perfect place. You have found your community of like-minded, like-hearted, like-spirited parents, caregivers, teachers, and advocates. You get to relax here. Perhaps for the very first time in a learning environment, you get to feel at home, set down your baggage, and show up to the learning process as if it is magical, as if you are a child seeing learning for the first time. And remember, we learn how to walk by falling down.



So there will be times in this process where there's nerves, or there is a sense of unknown, or a sense of distress that you're not taking in all of the information as quickly as you should be. And that's my second invitation for you. The first is to allow yourself to believe that you belong here and that you're in the perfect place for us. You are absolutely unconditionally welcomed here just as you are. And the second is for you to support yourself when you're struggling to remember the material or you're believing that you have to get it perfect, to trust that this is a lifelong process. If at any time in our program, you need to take a break from the homework, pause, and reread that page 50 times in order for you to remember it, it's okay. Pace of permission. You get to move at your own pace and you're going to be a great coach and a great parent, caregiver, teacher, grandparent, even if you don't perfectly memorize everything that you're learning. That's my second gift for you. I will remind you of this every step of the way. And mostly I'm so excited that you're here and I'm looking forward to moving through what we have today together.

So what I would like to invite you, if at any time you do notice your mind or body slipping into fear, stress, or anxiety, I'm going to invite you to take in this little gift, this phrase, this story, this narrative, this mantra that you can use and our devotion and commitment to you as a team, as a community, as a movement is that you are here to be seen, supported, and inspired. You are not here to be fixed. You are not broken. Your child is not here to be fixed. They are not broken. Your relationship with your child is not here to be fixed. It is not broken. And your mind and body may be believing the contrary, and we're going to practice this together. The second is you are here to nurture your innate strengths and superpowers as a parent. You are not here to become a perfect parent who never makes a mistake. It's true. You are here to believe, for perhaps the very first time, that it's never too late to mend or repair disconnection. We have students in our program who are in their seventies, whose children are in their fifties, and they've been parenting from control, fear, coercion, and shame their entire life. And they come here and they begin the mending process. It is possible. I guarantee that. And finally, you are here to remember how to be kind and empathetic with yourself. You are not here to focus and highlight all of your shortcomings and your failures, and everything you're doing wrong or bad. That's not very motivating to grow as a parent, coach, and leader. We're going to be focusing and celebrating every step of the way for what's going great and everything that *is* working. That's a completely different mindset than what most of us move through our days with. If you're willing to agree to these gifts, even just a tiny bit, then I applaud you and I celebrate you here as well. Every week, you're going to have a workbook that accompanies your weekly video audio here, and it will support you to integrate and digest the material that you're learning. There's exercises, there's prompts, and there's opportunities for you to become self-reflective and fill out questions that will help to ground and orient you here.



So our very first workbook is week one, setting your intentions as an empowered parent, and I invite you to go ahead and take that workbook out now, if it's not already with you. And if at any time throughout the audio here forward, you'd like to go ahead and pause in order for you to fill out the workbook, that's just fine. And if you need to take this workbook in bites, that's absolutely fine as well. This can take you an hour. This could take you two hours. This could take you 25 minutes. It depends on your style, your pace, where you are at in your process as a human and self-awareness, and the time that you need to take to really dig deep and get honest. And I do invite you to be as honest as you can be. If there is any question in this workbook that brings you to a place of falter, or you're just not quite sure how to answer it, go ahead and skip it. We don't need to focus and drain our energy on this one question that you're struggling with and that's challenging you. Focus on ease, focus on what is available, and that's going to give you the energy, the momentum, and the self-respect that you need to soar through our program and have those beautiful, magical moments of repair, mending, and growth.

Alrighty, go ahead and take out your workbook and we'll begin by looking at grounding into your strengths as a parent. So I've mentioned this already so far, and again, we are wanting you to begin this process with a mindset and a lens of strength. You may be here truly struggling as a parent. And I can assume that you don't spend a lot of time thinking about what you're good at and what's going well, and what you're strong at, or what your special, unique gift is as a parent. How often do we do that? Probably not ever. So how exciting that we get to do that together today, and I want this to be a symbol, a metaphor, and an anchor for you. You started this program by looking at your strengths and it is from your innate strengths that you are going to grow. We're not going to grow by hating ourselves, thinking that we need to be better, wanting to fix ourselves, or needing everything to be perfect immediately. That's not fertile soil for growth. What fertile soil for growth is, is for you to be moving forward, focusing on what you love, admire, and appreciate about yourself, your child, your children, and your family, and I'm excited for you to have that opportunity. If at any time through these questions, you feel grief, you feel a sense of, "I don't know what I'm good at, I don't know what my strengths are," let that be okay. It's okay. It doesn't mean there's anything wrong with you, or that there isn't anything about you that's strong, or that there's nothing about your life that's going well. It may take time for you to soften your body and your mind to answer that question. If you are someone who tends to focus on what's not going well and all of your shortcomings, let yourself revisit it after a couple of days and try again. I bet you'll find at least one thing. Go ahead and pause the audio now if you would like to get into that worksheet and then come on back and I'll lead you into the next.

So next, we're going to look at your support for inner and outer resourcing. It's very, very vital that you are supported, are supporting yourself, asking for help, and receiving help during your time in our program. You're going to get so nourished from our weekly group cohort meetings. You're going to get so nourished from your weekly practice coaching circle. You're going to be so nourished from these weekly audios and your workbooks, and there's never not enough support. I want you to be saturated with support going through this program. So we're going to take a look at the ways that you have already supported yourself. You're a grownup. I imagine that you have learned your ways of getting yourself through growth, edge, growth-oriented transitional times, times of potential challenge, or needing yourself to really dig deep and expand yourself. So we're going to go ahead and take a look at the ways that you resource yourself, meaning how do you support yourself? What tools do you already have in your tool basket that you can turn to at any time you feel, want, and desire in this program to be extra supported? Maybe there's a certain week or a certain reading that really lights you up on the inside and you're having a hard time settling. It's very normal. It's very normal in the learning process, especially when you're learning about parenting, looking at your parenting past. Looking at your relationship with your child can bring up healthy regret. It can bring up healthy discomfort. Those feelings are not bad or wrong. We're not wanting them to not happen. They're signals, they're communications, and you don't have to suffer in silence as you're experiencing those sensations in your body or your mind, you get to support yourself. So full permission from me to support yourself in whatever way that you need and you know that you will thrive if those needs are being met. If you don't know, and you're thinking I don't actually support myself very well. That's great because now you know that you have a space to grow in. You can talk with your weekly practice coaching circle about their resources. How do they support themselves? And you can gather information. You're in a social learning environment and you're going to be supported if you're not able to access those answers in your own self. So go ahead and pause the audio now, if you'd like to get into that workbook. If you'd rather revisit it at a later time, then we'll keep going.

Next, we're going to be moving into setting intentions. Intentions are arrows. Intentions create the trail. We've made a map for you, this beautiful map for you to move through and the trail is yours. You are the only one that can walk through it. You are the only one who is responsible for your trail. It's true. And your intentions create the path, it clears the weeds. It clears the clutter, it clears the brush, it helps you understand where you are and where you're going, even if the way is not always clear on the horizon. Intentions are not expectations. Intentions are not necessarily what's going to happen in the way that your mind perceives that it should, but it's going to keep you on your feet. It's going to keep you moving. So I invite you to become crystal clear. What is your intention for yourself?



Name three intentions for yourself, three intentions for your child and your relationship with your child. Take your time filling this out, listen to your heart. Don't listen to the fear in your brain. You don't want to set intentions from scarcity, lack, or fear. Let's dig into the heart, dig into a sense of trust and groundedness, and from there, create your intentions. And if that's difficult for you to ground and feel safe in your body, you can practice mindfulness and notice your breath. If taking deep breaths is difficult for you, you can just breathe normally and focus on your breathing. Imagine that your eyes and your brain are in your heart. Imagine that your mouth is in your heart, and you're letting that part of your being, your consciousness, and your body speak. And see what happens. Let yourself be surprised. Go ahead and pause the audio now if you'd like. And the fourth segment of your workbook is becoming aware of your personal values. And we're in a great deconditioning process. We're in a great unearthing process of who you believe that you were and are, based on how you were parented and who you actually are, which is quite exciting and sometimes confusing. So we're going to be supporting you to make that journey by becoming aware of your values. Your values are your anchor. So if your intentions are your path, your values are your water bottle and your snack pack is going to continue to strengthen you and nourish you as you're walking. Go ahead and pause the audio if you'd like.

Now we'll get into more of the underbelly of this process where transformation occurs. We're looking at your challenges as a parent. We all have them, don't be shy. There's no judgment at all. I imagine that I have experienced maybe almost everything that you could potentially write down on your paper. So I'm not afraid at all of your challenges and I invite you to trust that you are in the place that you've always wanted, where you get to be honest. You get to be honest about what your challenges are. You don't have to hide them anymore. You don't have to pretend that everything's okay. You don't have to blame the world or society or your partner, or your children, or anything else. You just get to write it down, you just get to say it. And then we're going to dig deep in our time together. So go ahead and pause the audio and you can get into that process. And our very last segment here in the workbook, as far as you feeling it out, is looking at your default pattern. It's looking at your relationship to stress. And why we're asking this question is simple self-awareness. Not that it's simple, but it's self-awareness, and ultimately self-compassion. If you're able to name when you're falling into your default pattern, you don't have to judge, criticize, and shame yourself. You simply get to name it and then you get to make a choice. We're going to practice that together. So some common default patterns are running away and saying, I'm over this, I'm not good at this, I'm done, this isn't where I'm supposed to be anyway and dropping it. Another one is shutting down, getting critical, getting resentful, and going into blame.



You could have a healthy mix of the both of them, like me. It's important and it's illuminating for you to be able to befriend your default pattern. So you're not trying to run away from your running-away-from stress. That makes it even more complicated. If we can have a naming process of what's happening and you can be transparent about it with your coach or your practice circle, "when times are hard and challenging for me, I shut down and I stop showing up. I don't do the homework. I don't do the reading. I stop coming to the calls." Okay, you know, you're not actually that unique. That's a very common way of dealing with stress and it's absolutely understood and validated. And let's figure out how to notice when you're slipping into that so you can recommit to this process. Okay? You can go ahead and pause the audio now.

Just a few more minutes with me, we're going to be going into your very first tools as a parent and a coach. The first is active listening. We're going to be spending a lot of time on this very, very foundational practice of being able to listen. Oh my goodness. It seems easy and it's not. And it's absolutely radically transforming for you in your own self, your self-esteem, your self-respect, and your self worth that you're able to listen. That feels good when you're able to show up for someone and truly see them and hear them. That feels really good. And not only does it feel good for you, it feels incredible for your child, your children, your partner, your family, your work, and everybody on the planet. So let's go through this quickly and this will be in your workbook if you'd like to follow along. If I elaborate in any way, and you'd like to jot down notes, you can do so. And the first is to listen intently. How I like to describe this is being in tunnel vision. So I imagine when my child is talking, I'm entering this portal or this tunnel where they are the only being in the entire planet. And they are the most precious thing I've ever seen. And mind you, there may be another child screaming, very close to you. There may be a puppy peeing on the carpet. I'm describing my morning, by the way. And it's still possible for you to tunnel vision into your child, give them your full eye contact, give them your full body language presence, get down on their level if they're little. Meet them in their body language if they're big, respect them, really look at them as if they are worthy of speaking, as if they are intelligent. They are genius. They have thoughts and opinions that matter, and that are valuable. And listen as if they're the most precious jewel you've ever seen. And please, if it happens one time a day for 10 seconds, that's great. That's great. That's a great starting point. So let's start small and let's snowball and build. Number two is listening without judgment. This is a practice that we are going to continue together throughout your time in the program, which is being able to listen with a neutral, non-judgmental filter. So not only are you listening intently as if they are the most precious thing on the planet, you're also listening without any kind of story in your brain. Comparing yourself to them, naming them as, for example, "they're so judgmental or they're a know it all."



Or they're so hard headed, so stubborn, and they talk way too much", which might be true. What we want to practice is being able to look beneath the language, beneath the behavior, at feelings, needs, thoughts, and beliefs at all times. Feelings, needs, thoughts, and beliefs. And we're going to practice that together. You may not know what I mean by that, and that's okay because I haven't taught you yet. So don't worry, you're going to learn how to do that. And the third is refraining from interrupting. You know if you interrupt, you know if you do. I do all of the time. And so we're being gentle with ourselves. We're also not judging ourselves as we're learning these four pillars of active listening. Practice, see how you can go into your day, just today, just start today, if you can truly listen to someone without interrupting them. This includes your spouse, your co-parents, your child, your children, your work mates. Can you listen to them and let them finish your sentence? Your body may be on fire. You may have to close your lips with your fingers. That's what a lot of our students have very hilariously shared, that in order for them to not interrupt, they had to clamp their mouth shut. Which makes sense, because most of us were not allowed to speak in our childhood homes. We were not heard. And so we grow up and we have so much to say, and we want to be heard and it can feel viscerally, like in our body, painful to keep our mouth shut. Especially when you have a three-year-old whose stories take about 25 minutes and you're not quite sure what they're talking about. And you're hungry, and a hundred other things are happening at the same time. Just notice.

And if you do need to interrupt, we can do it in a non-invasive way. So how I like to teach it is something like, [gentle halting hand movements], you know, you're gently entering their space. Their verbal, their energetic, their physical space. Instead of saying stop, you're doing it in a gentle, slow way. You can even teach your child, "I'm learning how to not interrupt you. You may see me do something weird like this [gentle halting hands]. I'm learning." And it's okay. You know, it's okay if you do interrupt, but notice if it's truly necessary. Do I truly need to interrupt right now, or can I wait? We're wanting to practice impulse control, aren't we? So we can teach our children how to not interrupt us as well. So notice the ways that you feel when your child or children interrupts you. Do you get enraged? Are you so annoyed and frustrated? And then notice how often you interrupt your children. It might be kind of funny for you. The better the sense of humor you have in this process, you're going to feel a lot less pain. I will tell you that. So just be curious and be playful with yourself. Be open and have a sense of humor when you notice yourself slipping into interrupting. And the fourth is refraining from comparison. This is important. We're wanting to, to the best of our capacity on a daily basis, refrain from comparing ourselves to other parents. If you are a parent who spends your time on social media, scrolling and looking at all the other parents and how amazing they are, and they probably don't yell, and they probably don't ever feel any kind of emotion other than peace.



You know if that's you. Notice how you can soften, how you can soften that coping strategy. When you're feeling insecure or lacking confidence, lacking skill, how can you focus on your own self, versus comparison? And notice how you compare your child to others, their siblings, or their cousins. Maybe reflect on how you may have been compared to your siblings, school mates, or cousins. It's an energetic drain, and it's disrespectful and disempowering. And I don't expect you to do this perfectly, by the way, I still do it all the time. We're wanting to expand our awareness and our consciousness. So where we put our energy, that's where things become illuminated. So it's an invitation for you, right? That is active listening. We're going to be practicing this in every group session and every practice coaching circle, and in every session for the rest of your life when you're a coach. All right?

So the very last topic that we have today is reflective listening. This is simply repeating back what you've heard. And if you have littles and they come to you, and they're telling you this really exciting story, and you think you kind of understand what they're saying. And if you can repeat that, at least the last three to five words, that's all they need. They don't need, you know, to say, "You're amazing! You're so creative! And I can't believe I get to be your mom!" Unless you really, really want to do that. But what would serve them the best is to let them know that you see them and that you hear them. And how that is met for almost every human is reflecting back what you heard them say. "Yes, I heard you say this and this and that, is that right?" "Yes!" "Thank you for telling me that." For a lot of children, that's all they need. "Watch me mommy, watch me mommy, watch me mommy." "Yes I see you, you're on the yellow slide and you're going down!" Being able to simply reflect back what you heard them say or what you see them doing. We're going to go into this a lot more moving forward as well. This is your introduction.

So notice how you can invite reflection into your communication with your child, children, students, partner, co-parent friends, and family. And you can also request that the people in your life reflect back your words too. "You know, it would be awesome and I would feel really heard and seen if you could just let me know when I'm done talking that you heard me. Is that something you're willing to try?" Give it a try. All right. Yay! So glad you're here and I can't wait to get deeper and deeper, and bigger and bigger with you, as we move through this process. And I'm looking forward to seeing you all in our group session and please enjoy the rest of your day. Please enjoy your child, your children, and I will speak with you all very soon. Thank you.

